Personalized Career Assessment

SAMPLE

Sample report · prepared by Raffi Simonian · raffi-simonian.com

Every real plan is generated from your own Ikigai answers plus six planning questions, and includes my personal review notes by email.

Your Direction

Your four Ikigai answers and six planning answers point the same way: you come alive at the intersection of storytelling and bringing people together — running your organization's social media, filling rooms, watching a post or an event land — and your strengths match it: public speaking, fast clear writing, and staying calm when plans change. Add your stated cause (education and career access for first-generation students), your non-negotiables (mission-driven work, a collaborative team, real learning on the job), and your timeline (employed in the field within nine months), and the direction writes itself: communications and engagement roles in education-access organizations — communications coordinator, digital content specialist, or program and events coordinator at a nonprofit, foundation, or university advancement office.

Achievement, in your own words, is holding one of those roles within nine months of graduation while staying in the Los Angeles area. That is realistic: your target quarter-by-quarter plan below is sized to the ten hours per week you said you can invest alongside your final two quarters, and it is built on the pathway this site teaches — skills compound into competencies, competencies earn credentials, credentials unlock achievement.

Your Non-Negotiables & Deal-Breakers

- Mission-driven work — you named education access specifically. Tradeoff you accepted: early salaries in nonprofits often run 10–20% below market; you said a $55–60k floor makes that workable.
- Collaborative culture — your strengths are team-shaped. Tradeoff: more meetings, more compromise on creative control.
- Learning and growth — a team that teaches beats a prestigious logo that doesn't. Tradeoff: the best teaching environments are often smaller, lesser-known organizations.

Your deal-breakers, turned into filters for any offer: work with no visible audience or outcome (it starves what energizes you); a culture that treats communication as an afterthought; and a commute over an hour each way. Apply all three to every posting before you invest an application.

Where You Stand Today

Ready to leverage now: public speaking, fast and clear writing, event coordination, social media management for a real organization — these are competencies with evidence behind them, and per the NACE 2026 Job Outlook, communication and teamwork sit at the top of what employers want on new-graduate resumes.

Needs evidence: campaign measurement. You can run a channel; you have not yet proven you can report its results in numbers. One measured campaign fixes this.

Credentials to add: your BA (June 2027) is the anchor credential. Add two market-recognized micro-credentials that signal job-ready skills: a Google Analytics certification (free) and an email-platform certification such as Mailchimp Academy or HubSpot Email Marketing (free). Burning Glass's 14 Most In-Demand Skills lists analyzing data among the business enablers employers want across the economy — these two credentials put numbers behind your storytelling.

The gaps this plan closes: measured-campaign evidence, analytics and email credentials, a working professional network in education-access organizations, and interview fluency.

Year 1 — The Execution Plan

Month 1 — November 2026. Learning: start the Google Analytics certification (3 hrs/week). Networking: list 20 LA-area education-access organizations and 10 people two or three years ahead of you in them; send your first 3 outreach messages (the proximal-peer scripts from your coaching materials work verbatim). Interview readiness: rewrite your top 5 resume bullets as outcomes with numbers using the PAR method. Search tactics: set job alerts for "communications coordinator" + education/nonprofit within 25 miles. Portfolio: pick your strongest past campaign and write it up as a one-page case study. Milestone: analytics course 50% done, 3 outreach messages sent. Checkpoint: did anyone reply? If not, revise the message, not the plan.

Month 2 — December 2026. Learning: finish and pass Google Analytics. Networking: 3 more outreach messages; hold your first 2 informational conversations. Interview readiness: draft answers to the five most common behavioral questions from your case study. Search tactics: apply to 2 postings purely for practice. Portfolio: instrument your student-org social channels so next quarter's numbers are measurable. Milestone: first credential earned; 2 conversations held. Checkpoint: what did the conversations change about your target list?

Month 3 — January 2027. Learning: start the email-platform certification (Mailchimp or HubSpot). Networking: 4 outreach messages; 2 conversations; ask each person "what would you do differently in your first six months?" Interview readiness: one mock interview with your campus career center. Search tactics: apply to 4 real postings; log every application. Portfolio: run one measured campaign for your student org (a recruitment push or event promotion) with a stated goal. Milestone: 6 applications total, campaign live. Checkpoint: is your response rate above 10%? Below that, have a peer review your resume.

Quarter 2 — February–April 2027. Finish the email certification. Grow to 8 applications per month, prioritizing organizations from your conversations — referred applications convert several times better than cold ones. Hold 2 informational conversations per month; by April you will have spoken with 10+ people in the field. Write up the measured campaign as case study #2 with numbers ("grew event attendance 40%", "3.2% click-through"). Do a second mock interview. Consider one Parker Dewey micro-internship (paid, short, remote) if coursework allows within your ten hours. Milestone: 2 credentials + 2 case studies + 25 cumulative applications. Checkpoint: are you getting first-round interviews? If not, the resume is the bottleneck; if you interview but don't advance, rehearse with the behavioral drafts.

Quarter 3 — May–July 2027. Graduation quarter: shift the ten hours from learning to searching — 10 applications per month, half through your network. Ask your three warmest contacts directly: "who should I talk to about openings this summer?" Interview in earnest; after each one, log the questions you were asked. Negotiate with data: the NY Fed's Labor Market for Recent College Graduates gives you grounded

salary expectations for communications roles. Milestone: degree in hand, 5+ first-round interviews completed. Checkpoint: every rejection with feedback is a free coaching session — what pattern do you hear?

Quarter 4 — August–October 2027. Close. Target: signed offer by October — month nine of your stated timeline. Keep 10 applications per month until signature; do not stop at a verbal offer. Apply your three deal-breaker filters before accepting. If two offers land, weigh them against your non-negotiables in writing. Milestone: offer accepted in an education-access communications role at or above your floor. Checkpoint: does the role pass all three filters? If it fails one, name the tradeoff out loud before you sign.

Year 2–3 Roadmap

Phase 1 — Own a channel (through mid-2028). In your first year on the job, take one channel end to end and build a portfolio of three campaigns with measurable results. Decision point at month 12: is this organization teaching you? If not, your two credentials and three case studies travel well.

Phase 2 — Own a program (through mid-2029). Run a campaign or program outright — a giving day, a recruitment cycle, an annual event — and present its results to leadership yourself. Target title by Year 3: senior coordinator or communications manager, with the choice of a bigger nonprofit, university advancement, or ed-tech as the next move. That is your stated achievement, reached on your stated clock.

Risks & How the Plan Bends

- The final-quarter crunch (ten hours becomes four): protect networking first — conversations compound, courses can pause. The credentials move to summer; the timeline holds.
- A thin response rate in Q2: plan B is a Parker Dewey micro-internship or a volunteer communications role for a local education nonprofit — four weeks of real evidence beats forty more cold applications.
- An offer that fails a filter arrives in month seven: the plan bends but doesn't break — a role adjacent to the mission (marketing at an ed-tech company) is a training arc, not a betrayal, if you name it that and set a return date.

Measures of Success

- Google Analytics certification earned by December 31, 2026.
- Email-platform certification earned by April 2027.
- 10+ informational conversations held by April 2027.
- 2 measured case studies written by April 2027.
- 50+ logged applications and 5+ first-round interviews by July 2027.
- Offer accepted in an education-access communications role by October 2027 — within your nine months.

Next Steps

This week: start the analytics course, rewrite five resume bullets with the PAR method, and send your first outreach message — momentum beats perfection.

- NACE 2026 job outlook report (https://raffi-simonian.com/files/nace-2026-job-outlook-report.pdf) — what employers actually prioritize in new-graduate hiring this cycle.
- 14 Most In-Demand Skills (https://raffi-simonian.com/files/14-most-in-demand-skills.pdf) — map your communication strengths to the skills employers name most.
- The Labor Market for Recent College Graduates (https://www.newyorkfed.org/research/college-labor-market) — ground your salary expectations in live data before you negotiate.
- LinkedIn Grad's Guide 2026 (https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/linkedin-grads-guide-2026-linkedin-news-svpqe/) — first-job-search tactics for this exact market.
- Apply for Micro-Internships - Parker Dewey (https://info.parkerdewey.com/student/ucla) — short paid projects that turn skills into portfolio evidence.
- Connect The Dots (https://www.ctd.ai/) — maps the network you already have, so outreach starts warm instead of cold.

I read every assessment personally and will email you my notes — what the AI got right, what it missed, and the first move I'd make — within 48 hours. And your $50 is credited in full toward any live coaching session, so when you're ready to pressure-test this plan, the next step is already paid for.